Activity 8 — Role-Play Observer Checklist

Service Recovery Under Pressure — The Wedding Catering Failure

Focus of this observation	Service recovery — HEARD, unconditional apology, limits and root-cause fix
You are observing	Role A — the Duty Manager
Setup	Pairs or trios. A = Duty Manager, B = Mr Wong, C = observer scoring against HEARD.
Duration	15 minutes

Observer: _____ Performer: _____ Round: 1 / 2

Tick DONE only where you actually saw the behaviour. 'What good looks like' is the standard — anything less is NOT YET.

#	What to observe	What good looks like	Done	Not yet
1	**HEAR — let the customer finish**	Allowed the photographs and the full account, however long. Note the time of the first interruption; inside 90 seconds is the common failure.		
2	**EMPATHIZE — named the actual loss**	The vegetarian guests with nothing to eat, the 35-minute delay in front of 200 people, the damaged cake. Generic 'I understand your frustration' scores zero.		
3	**APOLOGIZE — unconditional**	No 'if', no 'but', no 'however', no blaming the kitchen. Circle any conditional word used.		
4	**RESOLVE — concrete and immediate**	Stated the 40% refund as already authorised, and committed to taking the balance to the Director today with a callback time.		
5	**DIAGNOSE — explained the cause and the fix**	Named the run-sheet process gap and that it is being closed.		
6	**Established common ground before setting the limit**	'We both want this made right' — turned an adversarial exchange into a shared problem.		
7	**Set the limit once, without haggling**	Did not repeat or defend the 40%; restated the escalation path instead.		
8	**Produced a written process fix with an owner**	A specific system or procedural change, owned, plus how Mr Wong will be told what changed.		

Strongest moment — what worked, and why

One thing to change in the next round

The performer's own view (ask them first, before you give feedback)

Check your work: All five HEARD stages were delivered, your apology contained no conditional words, you set the 40% limit once without haggling, and you produced a written process fix with an owner.

© 2026 Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd. All rights reserved. · www.tertiarycourses.com.sg